Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥3

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣7

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦9

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 6
♥ K Q 10 8 3 2
♦ A 7
♣ A K 3

♠ A 8 5 2
♥ 7
♦ J 9 4
♣ Q J 8 7 4



♠ 10 9 7 4
♥ A 5
♦ K Q 10 5 3
♣ 10 2

♠ K Q 3
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 9 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦K

SOUTH's 2♥ raise shows 6-10 points and a least three trumps.

NORTH, with 19+ points, decides that game is almost a certainty and bids 4♥.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 8 6 3
♥ J 7 5 4
♦ A 8
♣ 5 3 2

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4



♠ A Q 4
♥ K 10 8
♦ J 10 9 5
♣ A J 6

♠ K 5 2
♥ Q 3 2
♦ 6 4 2
♣ Q 10 9 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♥3

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening - 15 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST has no 4-card Major suit she bids 3NT.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 6 4
♥ A 9 5
♦ 8 2
♣ A K 6 3

♠ A 9 2
♥ Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 3
♣ J 9 4



♠ 8 5
♥ J 8 7 2
♦ K Q 9 6
♣ Q 10 7

♠ K 10 7 3
♥ K 6
♦ 10 7 5 4
♣ 8 5 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by South
Lead: ♥4

With 6 points, SOUTH must respond to NORTH's 1♣ opening bid. While it is often correct to respond by bidding suits "up-the-line", SOUTH should skip over the weak ♦ suit in favor of showing the 4-card Major ♠ suit.

NORTH knows that SOUTH may only have four ♠s, but with four of her own she can support the suit. Since she has a minimum opening bid she merely raises to 2♠. With his minimum response hand SOUTH passes.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A 10 4 3 ♥ J 5 ♦ Q J 7 ♣ Q 10 7 3	
♠ Q J 6 ♥ A K Q 7 2 ♦ A 5 3 ♣ 6 4		♠ 7 5 ♥ 10 9 8 4 ♦ K 9 4 ♣ K 8 5 2
	♠ K 9 8 2 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 10 8 6 2 ♣ A J 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥			
All Pass			

3♥ by West
Lead: ♣7

With 17 points WEST is not strong enough to insist on game after EAST's raise, but is strong enough to invite with a 3♥ bid.

EAST, however, doesn't have anything extra, so declines to go further.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 8 3 2 ♥ K 10 9 ♦ A J 7 ♣ K Q 6	
♠ Q 5 ♥ 6 5 3 2 ♦ 10 4 3 ♣ A 7 4 3		♠ K J 7 6 ♥ A 8 7 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 10 8 2
	♠ 10 9 4 ♥ Q J 4 ♦ K Q 5 2 ♣ J 9 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♦9

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution. SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT. NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.